EXECUTIVE BRIEF · 30 OCTOBER 2026

SunGrid Member Copilot

An AI assistant that answers members' questions in seconds from SunGrid's own policies, and checks rooftop-rebate eligibility with the Incentive Program's service.

For members

Clear answers at any hour, with the policy they come from

For member support

Routine questions handled; hard ones passed to a person

For SunGrid

Never promises a rebate: the official service decides

Recommendation: go, to a limited pilot

Sajid Ali, Lead AI & Data Science

HOW IT WORKS, AND HOW IT DID

Tested on 20 member questions before any member uses it

A member asks about billing, rebates, installation or their membership

It answers from SunGrid's 14 policy documents and shows its sources

For rebates it asks the eligibility service, and never guesses an amount

18/20 test questions passed every automatic check

0 amounts shown to a member who did not qualify

3/3 rebate eligibility cases handled correctly

⚠ **Two misses:** one confident wrong answer, one refusal it did not need. Answers are not yet graded by people: a safety check, not an accuracy score.

Test run of 30 October 2026 · 20 questions across all five topics

COST

$6.40

AI model cost per 1,000 member questions, measured on our test run

AT SUNGRID'S SCALE

10,000 a month	~$64
100,000 a month	~$640

Hosting and team time are extra and larger. Kept predictable with a daily budget alarm, length caps and a cheaper model for simple steps.

gpt-4o at list prices. A move to AWS Bedrock changes the price, so we re-measure before launch.

RISKS

Four risks, and our plan for each

Eligibility service not ready — High

The risk: rebate decisions come from another team's system. If it is late or changes, rebate checks stop working.

Our plan: agree it with that team in week 1 and test it daily. If late, launch without rebate checks.

A wrong answer — Medium

The risk: the AI can misread a policy and answer confidently but wrongly. It happened once in our tests.

Our plan: check each answer against the policy it cites. Unsure answers go to a person.

Wrong member details — Medium

The risk: today members type in their own tier and income. A mistake gives a wrong eligibility result.

Our plan: members sign in, and their tier and address come from their SunGrid account.

Support team overloaded — Medium

The risk: questions the AI cannot answer safely go to support staff. Too many, and members wait.

Our plan: keep the pilot small, measure the volume, and agree reply times with support.

Not a risk: promising a rebate. Only the official eligibility service decides, and that is built in and tested.

RECOMMENDATION

Go, to a limited pilot: six weeks, then decide

Week 1
Agree and approve

Weeks 2–4
Build safely on AWS

Week 5
Pilot with support staff

Week 6
Go / no-go on the results

What the pilot delivers

- Sign-in, with tier and address from the member record
- A check that every answer is backed by a policy
- Hard questions passed to a support specialist
- Runs on AWS, monitored, with a cost alarm

What we will measure

- Questions answered without a person
- Answers graded correct by support staff
- Reply time and cost per question
- Rebate amounts given wrongly: must be zero

We need:

- **Eligibility team** test access, week 1
- **Support staff** for the pilot, week 5
- **Approvals** AWS and security, week 1
- **Budget** six weeks, approved today

Team: Lead AI & Data Science, one AI/DS Associate, one backend engineer at 50%